

8.5 THE EUROPEAN DIMENSION

OCR has taken account of the 1988 Resolution of the Council of the European Community in preparing this specification and associated specimen assessment materials. European examples should be used where appropriate in the delivery of the subject content. Relevant European legislation is identified within the specification where applicable.

8.5.1 European Dimension

The specification encourages candidates to study the work of European psychologists such as Freud, Piaget, Tajfel.

9 Key Skills

Key Skills are central to successful employment and underpin further success in learning independently. Whilst they are certificated separately, the Key Skills guidance for this qualification has been designed to support the teaching and learning of the content. Opportunities for developing the generic Key Skills of Communication, Application of Number and Information Technology are indicated through the use of a  in Sub-section 5. The wider Key Skills of Working with Others, Problem Solving and Improving Own Learning and Performance may also be developed through the teaching programmes associated with the specification.

The following matrix indicates where opportunities exist for at least some coverage of the relevant Key Skills.

	Communication	Application of Number	IT	Working with Others	Improving Own Learning and Performance	Problem Solving
Level 1	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Level 2	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

Detailed opportunities for generating Key Skills evidence through this specification are posted on the OCR website. A summary document for Key Skills coordinators showing ways in which opportunities for Key Skills arise within GCSE courses will be published during 2001.

10 Reading List

The suggested reading in this list represents readily available texts that adequately cover the specification content. The list is not exclusive and should not be regarded as prescriptive.

At the time of the publication of this specification Hodder and Stoughton are preparing a GCSE Psychology textbook to accompany this course. It will be endorsed by OCR for use with this specification subject to OCR's quality assurance procedure before final publication. For further details, please contact the Social Sciences Qualification team at OCR Birmingham Office.

Woods B

Psychology First

Hodder and Stoughton
ISBN: 0-340-80252-9

Reviews of books considered suitable for GCSE Psychology courses are a feature of occasional publications of the Association for the Teaching of Psychology (ATP). The publications include a regular Newsletter, a twice yearly journal, and a resource bank of teaching materials. The ATP also promotes contact between teachers through conferences for teachers and students. The ATP can be contacted at the following address:

The Association for the Teaching of Psychology
c/o The British Psychological Society
St Andrews House
48 Princes Road East
Leicester
LE1 7DR

General Texts for Students

Cullis T, Dolan L and Groves D	Psychology for You	Stanley Thornes (1999) ISBN: 0-7487-3627-1
Hayes N	A First Course in Psychology	Nelson (1993) ISBN: 0-17-448166-7
Woods B	Discovering Psychology	Hodder and Stoughton (1997) ISBN: 0-340-688300-0

General Texts for Teachers

Atkinson R, Atkinson R, Smith E and Bem, D	Introduction to Psychology	Harcourt Brace Jovanovich (1990) ISBN 0-15-543689-9
Banyard P and Hayes N	Psychology: Theory and Application	Chapman and Hall (1994) ISBN: 0-41-246440-3
Cardwell M, Clark L and Meldrum C	Psychology for A Level	Collins Educational (1996) ISBN: 0-00-322442-2
Eysenck M	Psychology: A Student's Handbook	Psychology Press (2000) ISBN: 0-86-377475-X
Gross R	Psychology: The Science of Mind and Behaviour	Hodder and Stoughton (1996) ISBN 0-34-064762-0
Hayes N	Foundations of Psychology	Routledge (1994) ISBN: 0-41-501561-8
Hill G	Advanced Psychology Through Diagrams	Oxford University Press (1998) ISBN: 0-19-917168-8
Malim T and Birch A	Introductory Psychology	Macmillan Press (1998) ISBN 0-33-366852-9

Social Psychology

Aronson E, Wilson T and Akert R	Social Psychology	Longman (1996) ISBN 0-32-102435-4
Baron R and Byrne D	Social Psychology	Allyn and Bacon (2000) ISBN 0-20-531131-8

Behavioural Psychology

Nest-Evans G and Nest-Evans A	Principles of Behavioural Analysis	Harper Collins (1994)
Malott R, Malott E and Trojan E	Elementary Principles of Behaviour	Prentice Hall (2000) ISBN 0-13-083706-7

Developmental Psychology

Davenport G	An Introduction to Child Development	Collins Educational (1995) ISBN 0-00-322258-6
McIlveen R and Gross R	Developmental Psychology	Hodder and Stoughton (1998) ISBN 0-34-069099-2

Individual Differentiation

Aronson E, Wilson T and Akert R	Social Psychology	Longman (1996) ISBN 0-32-102435-4
McIlveen R, and Gross R	Developmental Psychology	Hodder and Stoughton (1998) ISBN 0-34-069099-2

Cognitive Psychology

Baddeley A	Your Memory: A User's Guide	Prion (1998) ISBN:1-85-375213-4
Gross R and McIlveen R	Aspects of Psychology: Memory	Hodder and Stoughton (1999) ISBN: 0-34-074792-7

Bio-psychology

Green S	Principles of Bio-psychology	Lawrence Erlbaum Associates (1994)
Sarafino E	Health Psychology: Bio-Psychosocial Interactions	John Wiley and Sons (1990)

Coursework and Methodology

Coolican H	Introduction to Research Methods and Statistics in Psychology	Hodder and Stoughton (1996) ISBN 0-34-067937-9
Clegg F	Simple Statistics	Cambridge University Press (1990) ISBN 0-52-128802-9
Maglennon K	Essential Practical Psychology	Collins Educational (1993) ISBN 0-00-322296-9

Websites

<http://www.bps.org.uk>

The British Psychological Society website

There are many useful websites available, but users should verify the validity of any information.

11 Arrangements for Candidates with Special Needs

For candidates who are unable to complete the full assessment or whose performance may be adversely affected through no fault of their own, teachers should consult the *Inter-Board Regulations and Guidance Booklet for Special Arrangements and Special Consideration*.

In such cases, advice should be sought from the OCR Special Requirements team (telephone 01223 552505) as early as possible during the course.

12 Support and In-service Training for Teachers

- A full programme of In-Service training meetings arranged by the Training and Customer Support Division (telephone 01223 552950).
- Specimen question papers and mark schemes, available from the Publications Department (telephone 0870 870 6622; fax 0870 870 6621).
- Past question papers and mark schemes, available from the Publications Department (telephone 0870 870 6622; fax 0870 870 6621).
- Examples of marked coursework.
- Written advice on coursework task proposals.
- A report on the examination, compiled by senior examining personnel after each examination session.
- Individual feedback to each Centre on the moderation of internally assessed work.
- A website: (www.ocr.org.uk).
- A Teachers' Handbook.

Appendix A: BPS Recommendation for Psychology Courses

From *The Future of A Level Psychology*, British Psychological Society, (1992)

Recommendation 8

- Educationalists, psychologists and psychology teachers should maintain and promote a commitment to human dignity, equality and social justice. It is appropriate to use the teaching of Psychology to promote these values, and explicit acknowledgement of this should be made in appropriate contexts.
- All students should be able to feel included within the content of Psychology. Society is pluralist, and it is therefore important to acknowledge that some groups of people have life experiences that are not part of the content of mainstream Psychology. This will require special emphasis to be put on cultural, social and individual diversity.
- Language is not neutral; it conveys value systems. Psychology courses at all levels should avoid the use of sexist or racist language, or any term that devalues the experience of some people.
- It is possible to illustrate most psychological concepts with a number of different studies. In drawing up syllabuses, and in teaching Psychology, care should be taken, wherever possible, to use examples that are relevant to the widest possible range of people.

Appendix B: Ethics in Psychological Research

GUIDELINES FOR GCSE students

Teachers are advised to duplicate these guidelines and distribute them to candidates.

1 Aim

The aim of this document is to give guidelines to students involved in behavioural research in schools and colleges. It addresses many of the major issues, but does not cover all of them. Whilst the following guidelines refer to behavioural research in general, they are written specifically with psychological research in mind.

2 Introduction

Ethical issues arise whenever psychological research is carried out and you will need to consider these. Psychological investigations may have ethical implications for those participating in the study, others they have contact with, members of the public, the researcher and the reputation of Psychology. You need to consider the rights and welfare of the people involved, the value of the knowledge obtained and the need to promote and maintain a positive image of Psychology. Psychological research can be fun, but it should not be carried out just for fun.

If you ask people to help you with your research, they have the right to refuse. Respect their rights at all times and avoid exploiting them for your own interests.

Here are some of the questions you will need to ask yourself about the study you carry out:

Should I be conducting this kind of study at all?

What is the most ethical way of carrying it out?

Am I sufficiently competent to carry it out?

Have I informed the participants of all they need and would expect to know before taking part?

Have they willingly agreed to take part?

How do I ensure that all research records are confidential and anonymous, and will remain so?

How do I ensure that my research is carried out professionally and in a way that protects the rights of those involved?

3 Choosing the best method of study

However interesting your idea might seem, you should only proceed if your study can be ethically justified. You should familiarise yourself with previous relevant research and findings, and you should consult someone who is suitably experienced. The first person to approach will probably be a psychology teacher or lecturer.

4 Competence

You need to work within your limits, and seek advice from your teacher or lecturer in order to establish your competence level.

People may ask your advice because they know you are studying Psychology. They may want help with personal problems which may be beyond your level of competence. Be very careful how you respond and do not claim to be more skilled or better qualified than you really are.

5 Consent

Participants should be volunteers and told what your research is about. Whenever possible obtain their informed consent, making sure participants fully understand what they are agreeing to.

You will need to emphasise rather than cover up aspects of the study that might affect someone's willingness to help. It is unethical to deceive people into taking part by saying the study is about something else. You should only withhold information if the research cannot be carried out in any other way.

Participants should be debriefed so they know exactly what the study was about – be prepared to answer any questions. Their own results should be made available to them. If participants will be distressed or annoyed when you give them feedback at the end of the study you should not proceed.

Participants have the right to withdraw from your study at any time – make sure they realise they can do this. Be prepared to stop the study immediately if you sense discomfort.

Participants should not be intimidated or pressurised into continuing when they do not want to, however inconvenient it is for you. You should be aware that participants may see you as threatening, or in a position of influence, simply because you are undertaking research.

Some people may be unable to give their own informed consent. These may include children, the elderly and those with special needs. Every effort must be made to seek permission from those with responsibility for these individuals.

For research conducted in your own school or college, you should first obtain consent from the headteacher – this consent may also be required from parents or guardians. The headteacher will be able to advise you on this.

Participants should be drawn from the candidate's own school or college, whenever possible. Consent is not needed when carrying out naturalistic observations of behaviour where an individual might expect to be observed, but people's privacy should be respected. It is always best to check whether consent is required. Be aware that others may regard your behaviour as suspicious.

6 Confidentiality

Respect your participants' privacy by treating data as confidential. Others should be unable to identify those who have taken part in your study. Many researchers assign numbers or initials to participants, both to identify them in their reports and to maintain their anonymity. You may need to discuss your data with other researchers or your supervisor, so let participants know if you intend to do this. It is unethical to divulge individual data unless a participant has provided written permission for you to do so. Records should be kept safely and not left where others can gain access to them.

7 Conduct

You should always be honest about your own competence and limitations. You are unlikely to be an expert in diagnosis, psychotherapy or psychological testing. It is unethical to claim that you are.

Make sure you consider the welfare of those affected by your study. Maintain the highest standards of safety, ensuring that apparatus is safe and that participants do not attempt embarrassing, dangerous, painful or illegal tasks. Your study must be designed so that those involved are not exposed to physical or psychological risks at any time. If in doubt, discuss this with your Psychology teacher or lecturer, and if necessary, be prepared to abandon your study.

You should **never**:

- insult, offend or anger participants;
- make participants believe that they have harmed or upset someone else;
- break the law or encourage others to do so;
- contravene the Data Protection Act;
- illegally copy tests or materials;
- make up data;
- copy other people's work;
- claim that somebody else's wording is your own.

Appendix C: Notes for Candidates writing up an Investigation

The report should be up to a maximum of 1,500 words in length, excluding graphs and tables. The report should be written under the headings listed below. It is best to start each section with a fresh sheet of paper because this makes corrections easier.

Photographs of people must not be used without written permission from the individual(s) in the photograph.

Title

Give your research a title that describes what you were investigating (for example, ‘An Investigation into the effect of chunking on recall’).

Abstract

A summary of your general aims, method, participants (subjects), results and conclusions. You should write no more than a paragraph.

Introduction

This sub-section explains the theoretical setting for your work and reasons for your choice of method. Points can include:

- background to the general area of study;
- previous research;
- terminology and concepts used in this area;
- how the hypotheses for this study were developed;
- methodological considerations that may affect the results (for example, choice of sample);
- aims of the study.

Hypotheses and Research Aims

Write up the research in a formal way (for example, stating your prediction as to how the variables are going to affect each other if you are doing an experiment, or what link there is if it is a correlation).

Alternatively, state your research aims in a clear way that indicates how they will be achieved, if, for some reason, you are not able to make a prediction about your research.

Method

Divide this section up into the following sub-headings:

- **Design:** type of investigation identified and described, and why you chose this design. Clearly identify any measured or controlled variable(s); explain how and why you measured or manipulated any variable(s).
- **Participants:** type of sampling method chosen and details of the sample including number, gender, age, occupation. Try not to refer to the participants as 'subjects'. Not all of these details can be described, as in, for example, an observation.
- **Materials:** were any special materials or apparatus (mechanical or electrical equipment) needed? Describe it here. For example, how did you decide on your questions for a questionnaire or the words for a memory test. Briefly describe your materials but put any copies of materials such as questionnaires in an appendix, not in this section.
- **Procedure:** describe how you conducted the investigation. Include any standardised procedures you applied as controls to the investigation such as:
 - the way you approached the participants;
 - standardised instructions;
 - timing of stimulus materials;
 - scoring of tests or questionnaires;
 - location and time of study.

Write this section so that someone reading it could repeat exactly what you did.

Ethics

Describe the ethical considerations that you had to make and which you acted upon in your investigation. Mention the code of conduct that you used as guidance e.g.

Guidelines for GCSE Students in Appendix B.

Results

Present these as visually as possible, but also describe the data that you obtained. Tables, pie-charts, graphs, scattergrams or any other type of descriptive statistics can be used but each should be labelled clearly. Measures of central tendency are also useful to show the direction of your results. These can include means, medians and modes. Explain what your results mean in the context of the prediction in your hypothesis.

Discussion

In this section the following questions should be considered.

- What do the results mean?
- How do the results relate to the aim and / or the hypothesis?
- How do the results relate to the theory that was described in the Introduction?
- Do the results agree with, or challenge, the theory in any way?
- What modifications, if any, can be suggested to the theory in the light of this study?
- What criticisms, if any, can be made of the method that was used?
 - choice of design?
 - choice of sample?
 - choice of materials?
 - choice of procedure?
 - choice of location?
 - choice of controls?
- If the method had been improved in some way, how would this have affected the results?
- Were there any confounding variables?
- Were any ethical issues raised during the study dealt with appropriately?
- Suggestions for further work?

Appendix

Include the statistical workings as an appendix. Also include any details of the procedure that were not included in full in the method section, such as standardised instructions, examples of survey sheets, observation charts, drafts of questionnaires. Include a representative sample of the data you have.

References or Bibliography

The standard way of recording references in psychology is to include the full reference of every piece of research that is cited in the report. For GCSE, however, this is not the most appropriate way of recording the research because very few schools and colleges have access to primary sources. It is also not necessary for you to carry out research from primary sources. It is acceptable for you to record a bibliography which contains details of the books and articles you actually read. When details of the references are given, it is traditional to give the author, the date of publication, the title, the place of publication and the publisher. Any materials drawn from the Internet should include the relevant website address.